

most of the ones I've experienced or heard about), be honest. Tell her what you're doing. If you're valuable where you are, you would be surprised how many times she will do all she can to get you a counteroffer. If she can't or if she has some other motivation to not re-hire you, she will appreciate not being blindsided when you turn in your notice. — **Sarah Winfrey**

9 Things to Do When You Are Laid Off

Your company has announced a soon-to-come layoff, or you've been escorted out of the door. What's next? Before you panic and jump headfirst into job hunting, take a few moments to regroup. Looking at your current situation from a big-picture point of view will give you a better sense of where best to go from here.

1. Review your financial status.

Check in on your accounts and figure out how much money you have.

2. Add up your fixed expenses.

How many months can you survive before your personal financial situation moves from good to bearable to desperate.

3. Evaluate your severance package.

Consider your options, which may involve a lump-sum payment or salary continuation.

If you are offered consideration (extra cash or some other benefit) for signing a non-compete agreement, think about the implications for locating a new job. If you signed a non-compete upon your hire or for consideration after being hired, see if you can get a clear definition of what companies or industries are considered competitors, or if the agreement is enforceable in your state.

4. Look at your benefits package.

Determine your life, health, and disability insurance coverage as well as your retirement plans. When will your benefits end? Do you need to replace your insurance coverage? If you are eligible for COBRA (Consolidated Omnibus Budget Reconciliation Act),